

Chapter 9 Test— Answer Key

Multiple Choice [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Circle the correct answer(s) from the choices below. Some will have more than one answer.

1. Choose all three principles for fruitful interreligious dialogue.
 - a. Acknowledge truth wherever it is found.**
 - b. Be charitable.**
 - c. Aim for getting a decision.
 - d. Expect consistent results.
 - e. Talk to a real person.**
2. All human beings are religious because . . .
 - a. we all want to know the meaning of life.
 - b. we all worship something.**
 - c. we all believe in the divine.
 - d. we all have rituals we follow.
3. According to Psalm 115:4–8, worship of entities, ideas, or objects other than God is . . .
 - a. a cult.
 - b. ideology.
 - c. a religion.
 - d. idolatry.**
4. The term *cult* may be used to describe . . .
 - a. a system of religious veneration.**
 - b. a divergent group within a larger religious body.**
 - c. a mainstream religion that has become unpopular.
 - d. a new religious movement or an alternative religion.**
 - e. a group that fixates on a striking leader to an extreme degree.**
 - f. a folk religion or neo-pagan religion.
5. The parable of the blind men and the elephant illustrates the idea that . . .
 - a. all religions are false but helpful for navigating life.
 - b. all religions have a partial understanding of religious truth.**
 - c. all religions lead to the same destination.**
 - d. all religions are equally valid.**
 - e. all religions agree with Christianity.
6. Philosopher John Hick theorized that . . .
 - a. the Real is the source of all religious truth.**
 - b. all religions are true because they are derived from the real.**
 - c. Christianity isn't the absolute truth about reality.**
 - d. all religions should be accepted as equally valid.**
 - e. Christianity is the primary truth, but other religions have some agreement.

7. Which religions borrow from Hinduism?
 - a. **Sikhism**
 - b. Judaism
 - c. **Jainism**
 - d. Taoism
 - e. Confucianism

8. Folk religions . . .
 - a. are centralized belief systems.
 - b. **are tribal religions with distinct gods, symbols, and rituals.**
 - c. **emphasize ancestral homelands.**
 - d. **seek harmony between humans, the natural world, and unknowable divine power.**

9. The cult that once practiced polygamy and believes humans can achieve godhood in the afterlife is . . .
 - a. **the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-Day Saints.**
 - b. Scientology.
 - c. Jehovah's Witnesses.
 - d. the Baha'i faith.

10. The religion influenced by Confucianism, Taoism, and Buddhism is . . .
 - a. Islam.
 - b. the Baha'i faith.
 - c. **Shinto.**
 - d. Scientology.

11. In 2 Timothy 4:3–4, Christians are told to . . .
 - a. trust in Christ alone for salvation.
 - b. **always be prepared to share the gospel.**
 - c. **know that people will follow attractive false doctrines.**
 - d. avoid relationships with unbelievers.

True or False [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, change the underlined word to make it true.

- F 12. Hinduism teaches that humans are unaware of their true spiritual nature and engrams that cause pain, illness, and irrational behavior. Scientology

- T 13. The New Age movement borrows heavily from Eastern religions and promotes karma, reincarnation, meditation, and channeling. _____

- F 14. Religious pluralism refers to the state of being culturally affiliated with a particular religion but not actively practicing it. Religious nominalism

- F 15.** The Real is a conversation that seeks to foster understanding between people of different religions. Interreligious dialogue
- T 16.** Pagan religions often involve occult practices and spiritism, which are forbidden by the Bible. _____
- T 17.** 1 Timothy 2:5 contradicts the claims of religious pluralism. _____
- F 18.** Hinduism has two main branches: Theravada (in which only religious leaders attain enlightenment) and Mahayana (in which anyone may attain enlightenment).
Buddhism
- F 19.** Judaism teaches followers to keep five religious “pillars” of confession of belief, prayer, fasting, giving, and pilgrimage in hope of gaining God’s approval. Islam

Fill-in-the-blank [Each answer is worth 2 points. Questions 20, 21 and 25 are worth 4 points.]

Fill in the missing word(s) to complete each statement.

- 20.** Jehovah’s Witnesses deny the Trinity and believe that Jesus was originally the archangel Michael.
- 21.** Hinduism and Buddhism are two main world religions with similar teachings that human beings are trapped in a cycle of reincarnation or rebirth.
- 22.** In Hinduism enlightenment comes through the four yogic paths of knowledge, love, work, and psychophysical exercise.
- 23.** Jehovah’s Witnesses believe only 144,000 people will be righteous enough to go to a spiritual existence in heaven while the remaining faithful will enjoy a physical, earthly paradise.
- 24.** In 1 Corinthians 1:23, the apostle Paul calls the gospel “a stumbling block to Jews and folly to Gentiles.”
- 25.** Acts 4:12 and 1 Timothy 2:5 are verses explaining that redemption through Jesus is the only way to salvation.

Short Answer [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions using complete sentences.

26. What are the three main monotheistic religions?
Christianity, Judaism, and Islam are the three main monotheistic religions.
27. How is a religion different from a worldview?
A religion specifically has to do with a response to the divine, whereas a worldview is a framework for seeing the world. Someone may follow Christianity but not have a Christian worldview.
28. Explain the difference between two approaches to religious pluralism.
Both approaches to religious pluralism seek to respect the dignity and freedom of all people to choose their religious beliefs. One approach promotes tolerance while recognizing that not all religions are true and that disagreement should be navigated with respect. The second approach affirms that all religions are true and discourages disagreement.
29. What are some characteristics of healthy interreligious dialogue?
Possible answer: Healthy interreligious dialogue is characterized by patience, listening, and curiosity. That means showing genuine interest in others and what they believe even when you disagree.
30. How do the views on salvation in Hinduism and Buddhism contrast with the Christian view? **Hinduism and Buddhism teach that “salvation” comes through enlightenment, which frees human beings from the cycle of reincarnation or rebirth. The Christian view is that salvation comes through faith in Christ who paid the penalty for our sin so we could be free from sin and death.**
31. How do Islam and Judaism’s views on salvation contrast with the Christian view?
Islam and Judaism teach that people must follow the law of God and be righteous in order to go to paradise with Allah or participate in God’s kingdom. Christians believe we are saved by faith, not by works of righteousness.

Essay [Each question is worth 5 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

32. Explain why philosopher John Hick’s view of the Real and the parable of the blind men and the elephant are flawed.
Both John Hick and the parable of the blind men and the elephant make the same mistakes. Both claim no religion has a full view of religious truth but both Hick and the teller of the parable assume that they have a God’s-eye view and can understand what all the world religions cannot. Both also fail to take the exclusive claims of the different faiths seriously.

True tolerance and love mean understanding differences but not dismissing them. In a way, Hick and this parable are intolerant of any view but their own.

33. Is it more compassionate to say that Christianity is the only way to God or to say that all religions lead to God? Explain your answer.

Possible answer: It's more compassionate to say that Christianity is the only way to God because there are good reasons to believe Christianity is true. Because Christianity explains that Jesus offers those who trust in him freedom from sin, death, and judgment, it's compassionate to tell people this truth. Saying that all religions lead to God is not only logically flawed, but it also fails to take the central claims of world religions seriously. It's not compassionate to tell someone that all religions lead to God when so many religions give people the burden of doing righteous works for salvation despite the fact that God's grace has made salvation freely available through Jesus.